



Collecting and organizing data

BEFORE INFORMATION CAN BE PRESENTED AND ANALYZED, THE DATA MUST BE CAREFULLY COLLECTED AND ORGANIZED.

What is data?

In statistics, the information that is collected, usually in the form of lists of numbers, is known as data. To make sense of these lists, the data needs to be sorted into groups and presented in an easy-to-read form, for example as tables or diagrams. Before it is organized, it is sometimes called raw data.

choice of drinks
COLA, ORANGE JUICE,
PINEAPPLE JUICE, MILK,
APPLE JUICE, WATER

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Bar graphs	206–209 >
Pie charts	210–211 >
Line graphs	212–213 >

Questions

Before designing a questionnaire, start with an idea of a question to collect data, for example, which drinks do children prefer?

Collecting data

A common way of collecting information is in a survey. A selection of people are asked about their preferences, habits, or opinions, often in the form of a questionnaire. The answers they give, which is the raw data, can then be organized into tables and diagrams.

information from these answers is collected as lists of data

Beverage questionnaire

This questionnaire is being used to find out what children's favorite soft drinks are. Put a cross in the box that relates to you.



1) Are you a boy or a girl?

☒

boy



girl

2) What is your favorite drink?



pineapple juice



orange juice



apple juice



milk



cola



other

3) How often do you drink it?



once a week or less



2–3 times a week



3–5 times a week



over 5 times a week

4) Where is your favorite drink usually bought from?



supermarket



deli



other

Questionnaire

Questionnaires often take the form of a series of multiple choice questions. The replies to each question are then easy to sort into groups of data. In this example, the data would be grouped by the drinks chosen.